

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which jobs actually make money?

Period: May 2026. Every job's gross margin: revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time at \$68 an hour (fully loaded: wages and all on-costs). Pick a type of job and every number, chart and note on the page follows it.

How final is this data?

April 2026

Locked

April 2026 is locked (closed 5 May 2026). These numbers won't change.

May 2026

Locked

May 2026 is locked (closed 2 Jun 2026). These numbers won't change.

October 2026

Incomplete

October 2026 is still in progress: figures to 6 Oct only.

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Job gross margin = revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time charged to the job at \$68 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: technician time not charged to any job (travel, training, waiting), and overheads (office wages, marketing, vehicles, rent, insurance, IT, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages always include all on-costs: super, payroll tax, workers' compensation insurance and leave.

From gross margin to profit

May's jobs made \$63,105 gross margin (39.0%). Technician time not charged to jobs took \$5,402 and overheads \$59,270, leaving (\$1,567) profit before tax ((1.0%) of revenue). To cover overheads, jobs need a 39.9% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on jobs	\$63,105
Technician wages and on-costs	\$54,600
Technician time charged to jobs (at cost)	\$49,198
Technician time not charged to jobs	\$5,402
Gross profit (the P&L)	\$57,703
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	\$59,270
Profit before tax (the P&L)	(\$1,567)
Revenue	\$161,963
Gross margin on jobs, %	39.0%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	(1.0%)
Gross margin jobs need just to cover overheads and time not charged	39.9%

Type of job: All jobs

Job gross margin, May · All jobs

39.0%

target 35.0%

Job gross margin, April · All jobs

41.7%

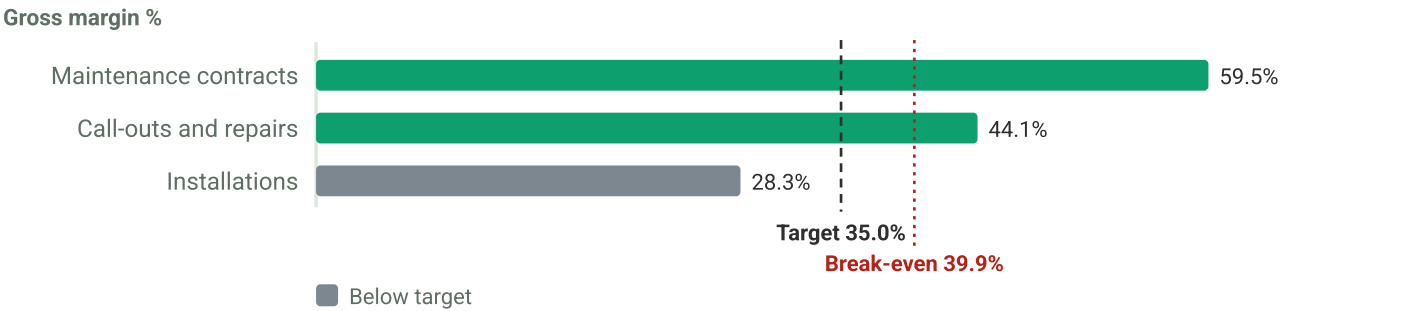
target 35.0%

Gross margin jobs need to break even

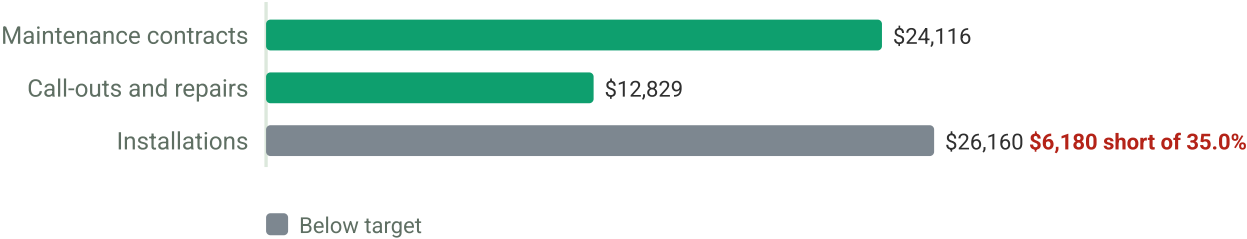
39.9%

covers overheads and time not charged (May)

Job gross margin by type of job, May 2026



Gross margin \$



What it shows

In May maintenance contracts made a 59.5% job gross margin, installations made a 28.3% job gross margin, call-outs and repairs made a 44.1% job gross margin (technician time at \$68 an hour, wages and all on-costs). Jobs need 39.9% just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Installations: 28.3% gross margin, 6.7 points under the 35.0% target: about \$6,180 on \$92,400 of revenue in May. It's below the 39.9% needed to cover overheads, too. Maintenance contracts: 59.5% gross margin, 24.5 points over the 35.0% target (\$9,941 ahead on \$40,500 in May).

Type of job: Maintenance contracts

Job gross margin, May · Maintenance contracts

59.5%

target 35.0%

Job gross margin, April · Maintenance contracts

59.6%

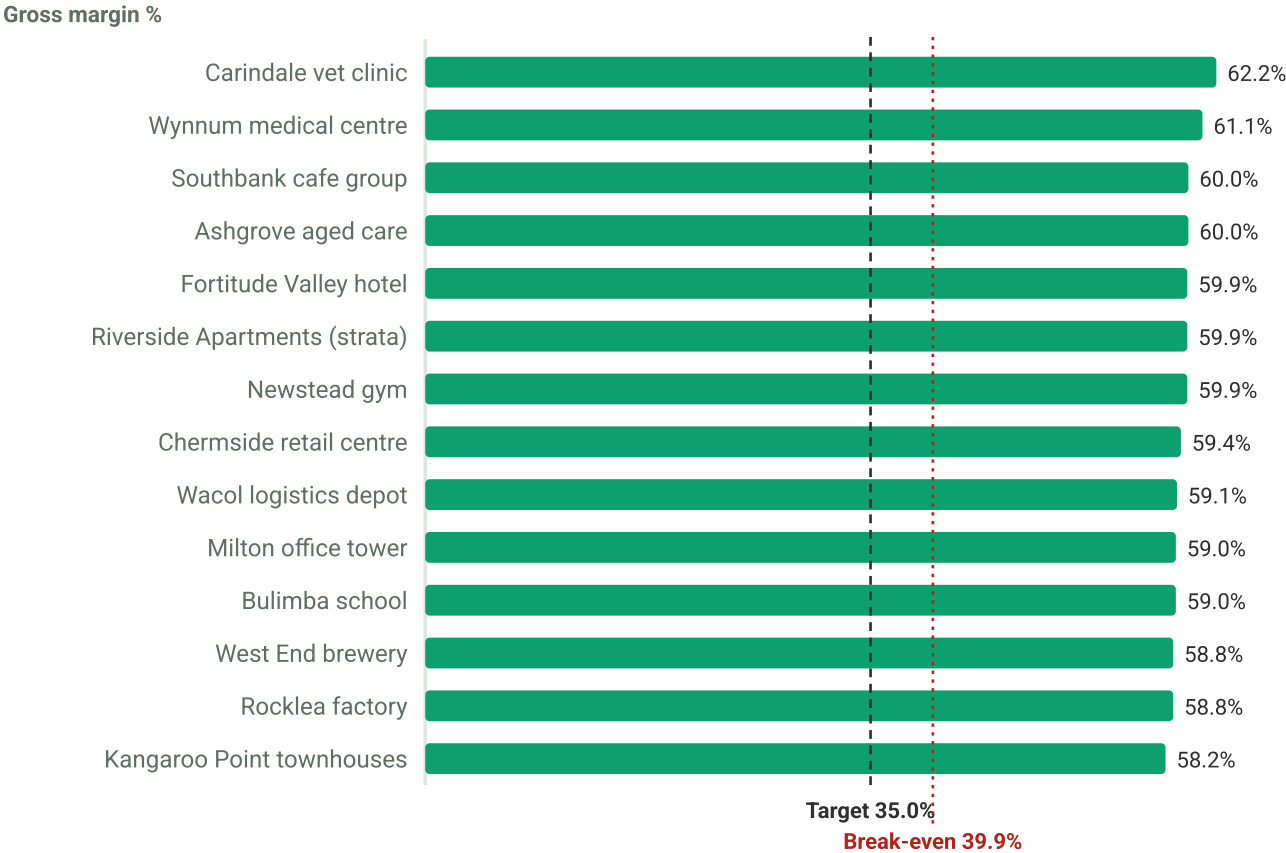
target 35.0%

Gross margin jobs need to break even

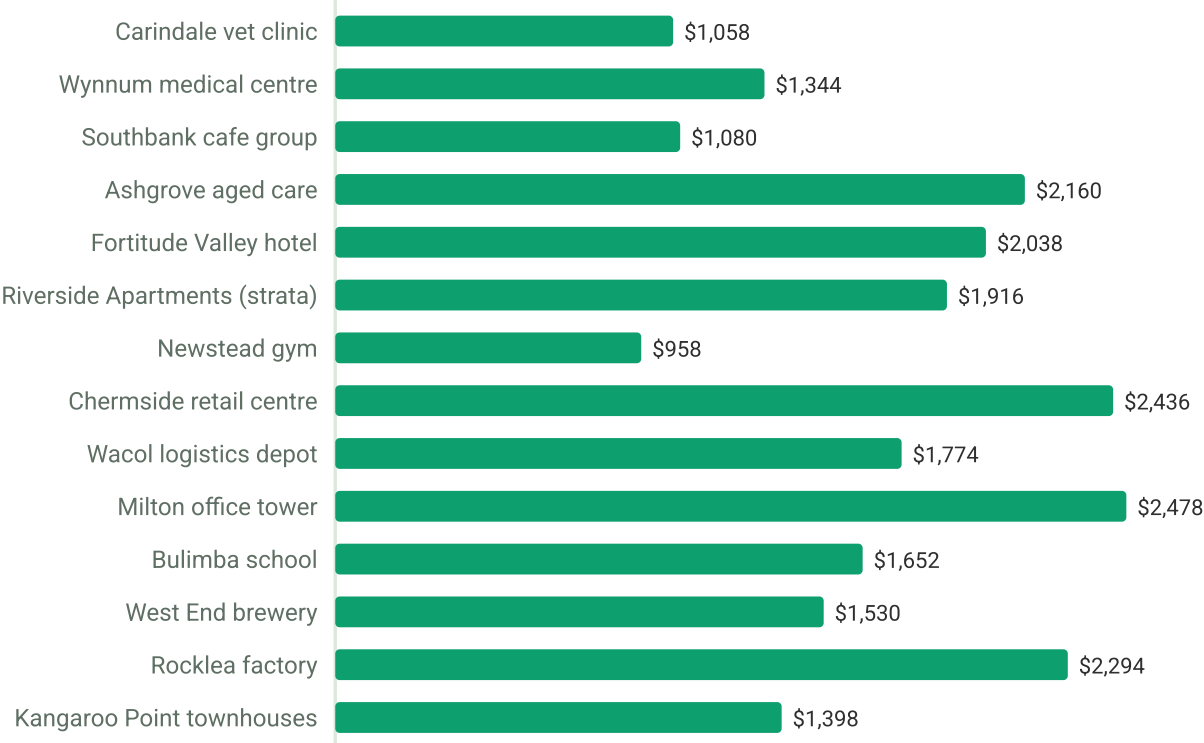
39.9%

covers overheads and time not charged (May)

Job gross margin on each maintenance contract, May 2026



Gross margin \$



What it shows

All 14 contracts made more than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The thinnest was Kangaroo Point townhouses at 58.2% job gross margin: 14.0 h of technician time on a \$2,400 monthly fee.

What you'd do about it

The thinnest, Kangaroo Point townhouses: 58.2% gross margin, 23.3 points over the 35.0% target (\$558 ahead on \$2,400 in May). All maintenance contracts: 59.5% gross margin, 24.5 points over the 35.0% target (\$9,941 ahead on \$40,500 in May).

Type of job: Installations

Job gross margin, May · Installations

28.3%

target 35.0%

Job gross margin, April · Installations

34.9%

target 35.0%

Gross margin jobs need to break even

39.9%

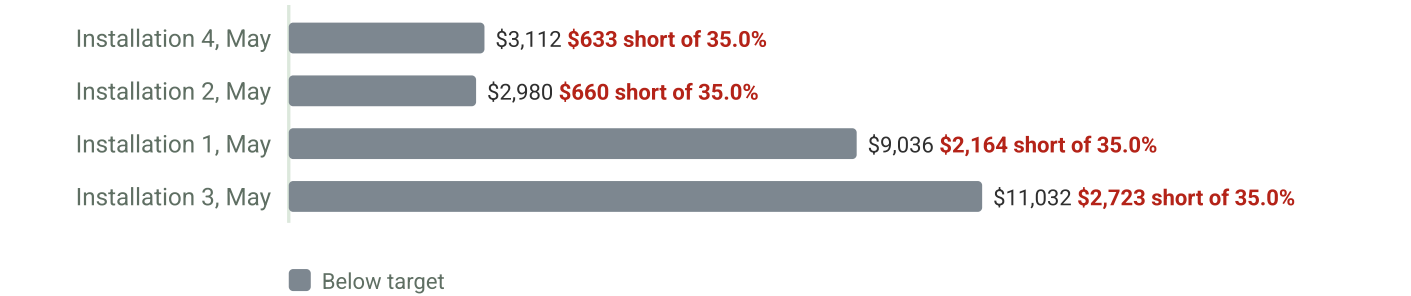
covers overheads and time not charged (May)

Job gross margin on each installation invoiced in May 2026

Gross margin %



Gross margin \$



What it shows

4 of the 4 installation jobs invoiced in May made less than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The Installation 3, May made a 28.1% job gross margin: 151.0 h of technician time (\$10,268) and \$3,100 of subcontractors on a \$39,300 job. Jobs need 39.9% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

4 installations under the 35.0% target, worth about \$6,180 between them on \$92,400 of revenue. The biggest gap, Installation 3, May: 28.1% gross margin, 6.9 points under the 35.0% target: about \$2,723 on \$39,300 of revenue in May. It's below the 39.9% needed to cover overheads, too.

Type of job: Call-outs and repairs

Job gross margin, May · Call-outs and repairs

44.1%

target 35.0%

Job gross margin, April · Call-outs and repairs

43.8%

target 35.0%

Gross margin jobs need to break even

39.9%

covers overheads and time not charged (May)

Technician time charged, May

\$20,379

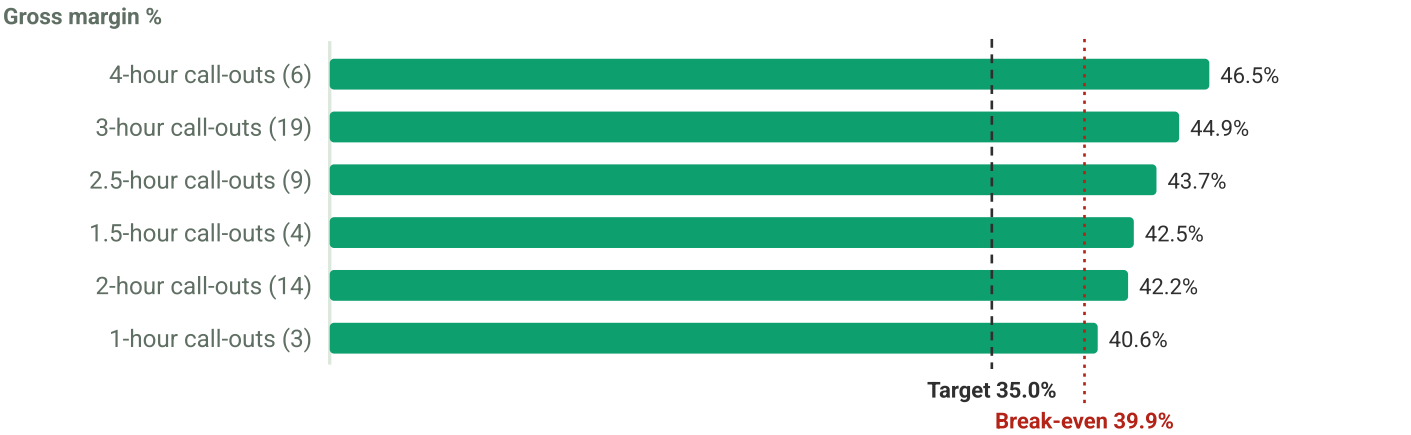
70.1% of call-out revenue

Materials charged, May

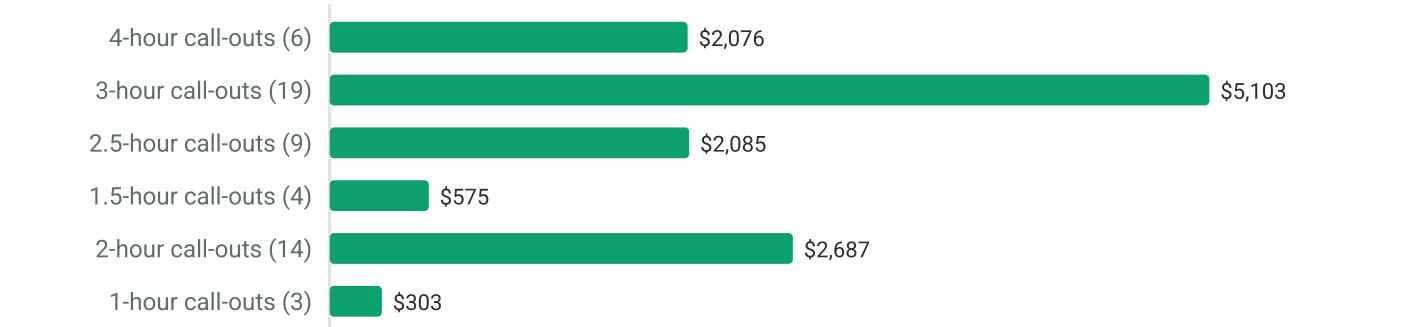
\$8,684

\$6,680 at cost, plus 30%

Job gross margin on call-outs by length, May 2026



Gross margin \$



What it shows

55 call-outs in May billed \$20,379 of technician time and \$8,684 of materials (\$6,680 at cost plus 30%), and made a 44.1% job gross margin between them. Gross margins run from 40.6% to 46.5% by length: the hourly rate covers technician time comfortably, so the gross margin mostly moves with how much material goes on the van.

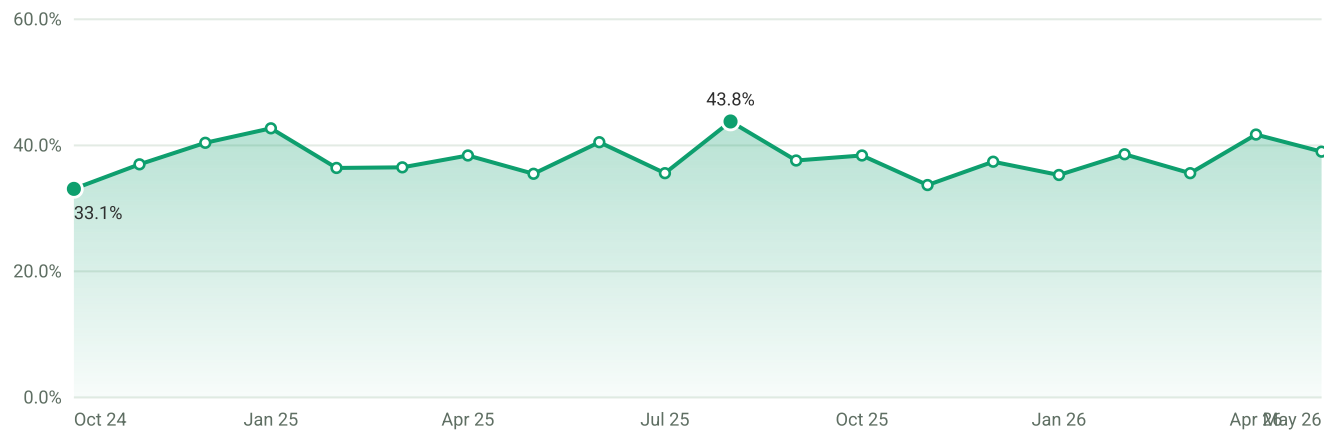
What you'd do about it

All call-outs: 44.1% gross margin, 9.1 points over the 35.0% target (\$2,657 ahead on \$29,063 in May).

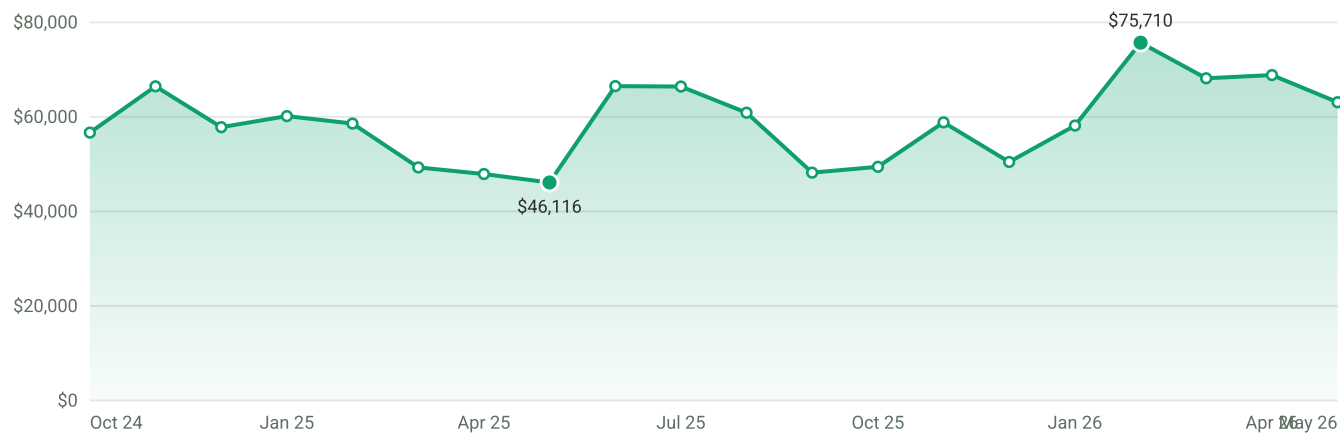
Every type of job at once

Job gross margin by month

All · Gross margin %



All · Gross margin \$



Tap a month for its workings. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.